Alison Whitwell
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Recent MA graduate with a strong foundation in social research, people development, and inclusive leadership. Experienced in team coordination, stakeholder engagement, and training delivery, with practical exposure to retail operations and process improvement. Passionate about the arts and driving equity, representation, and wellbeing in the workplace, with a particular interest in creative D&I strategy and culture-building initiatives. Brings a proactive mindset, strong communication skills, and a people-first approach to supporting recruitment, onboarding, and employee engagement activities. Eager to contribute to HR and people operations within purpose-driven organisations with a commitment to social impact and inclusive practices.

EDUCATION

University College London, London, UK — Sept 2022 – May 2024
First Class MA Sociology – Gender, Society, and Representation

- Achieved Distinction on dissertation exploring the relationship between trauma and identity-making
- Two essays – *Feminisation of Labour* and *Performativity & New Materialism* – archived as model submissions

Syracuse University, Syracuse, NY, USA — Aug 2017 – Dec 2020
Magna Cum Laude BFA (Hons) – Musical Theatre and Theatre Arts

- 3.8 GPA; Dean's List all 7 consecutive semesters

WORK EXPERIENCE

Total Focus Visuals Media - *International Operations Coordinator*, London, UK & Remote — Aug 2025 – Present

- Streamline data organisation and backup processes, maintaining structured digital systems to support efficient reporting and operational analysis
- Manage customer communications and feedback channels, providing insights to improve client experience and inform people-focused decision-making
- Coordinate international event logistics and supported employee wellbeing, ensuring smooth operations and sustained team performance

Powerlifting Coach, London, UK & Remote — Sept 2022 – Present

- Design and deliver personalised training programmes for 20+ clients, managing timelines, goal-setting, and outcome evaluation to ensure measurable success
- Maintain dynamic performance-tracking tools in Google Sheets, using weekly data insights to adjust plans and optimise results in line with evolving client objectives
- Oversee independent management of a client portfolio, coordinating planning, communication, and reporting to deliver projects on time and sustain high client retention

Lululemon - *Back of House Lead*, London, UK — June 2023 – Jan 2025

- Directed and prioritised a team of 10+, optimising daily shipment workflows and increasing operational efficiency by 300%, resulting in faster stock turnaround and improved floor readiness
- Analysed weekly sales and customer service data using Power BI and Salesforce to identify bottlenecks and drive process improvements, enhancing team performance and customer satisfaction
- Oversaw collaborative operational initiatives, including a pre-audit system that achieved 100% inventory accuracy across 36 cycles and monthly DEI presentations to 50+ staff, enhancing inclusion and team engagement

Athleta - *Acting Manager & Back of House Administrator*, Phoenix, AZ, USA — Jan 2021 – Sept 2022

- Led inventory and visual merchandising teams during shipment processing and store flips, improving operational efficiency by 25% through strategic resource planning and coordinated task execution
- Directed back-of-house operations for two new store openings, overseeing inventory flow, staff onboarding, and event planning to meet project deadlines and quality standards
- Managed payroll and onboarding workflows using Workday, delivering SOP training to 15+ new hires and ensuring 100% compliance with operational procedures

CERTIFICATES AND QUALIFICATIONS

IBM Business Analyst Professional Certification — Expected Completion: Sept 2026

- Currently completing IBM Business Analyst Certification, building skills in stakeholder analysis, process modelling, and data-driven decision-making using tools like Excel, SQL, and IBM Case Manager

SKILLS AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Technical Skills: Microsoft Office Suite (Excel, Word, PowerPoint), Google Drive, Mac OS, Outlook, Teams, Zoom, Power BI, Workday, Ceridian Dayforce, Salesforce, Oracle, Service Now

Soft Skills: Leadership & Team Coordination, Time Management & Prioritisation, Stakeholder Engagement, Problem-solving & Critical Thinking, Effective Communication (across teams and functions), Adaptability & Resilience, Analytical Thinking